Experiment 14 — Pro-Code Extension Using Zoho Catalyst

Aim

To study how Zoho Catalyst can extend low-code applications with pro-code functionality.

Theory

Zoho Catalyst is a developer platform for building and deploying applications and backend services using code. It can complement low-code platforms when more advanced functionality is required.

Features of pro-code development

1. Custom backend logic: Implements specialized business rules.
2. API development: Enables communication between applications and external systems.
3. Serverless functions: Runs backend code in response to supported triggers or requests.
4. Data processing: Performs specialized processing on application data.
5. External integrations: Connects applications to third-party services.
6. Scalability: Supports the development of services for more complex requirements.

Example

In the loan application system, Zoho Creator can manage forms and reports. A separate Catalyst service could perform specialized document processing or additional calculations and return results through an API.

Low-code versus pro-code

Low-code development	Pro-code development
Uses visual builders and predefined components.	Uses programming languages and developer tools.
Suitable for common business workflows.	Suitable for specialized functionality.
Requires less coding.	Requires more development expertise.

Enables rapid prototyping.

Provides greater implementation flexibility.

Challenges

- Requires programming knowledge.
- Needs additional testing and maintenance.
- Requires secure API communication.
- May introduce additional deployment and integration complexity.

Result

The role of Zoho Catalyst in extending low-code applications with custom pro-code functionality was studied.

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